MESA AI-NATIVE TRACK - COHORT C4
PRE-READ: GitHub Account Setup
Complete this before Lecture 1 on 18 September 2026

WHAT IS GITHUB AND WHY DO YOU NEED IT?

Every app you build this month will live on GitHub. Think of GitHub as Google Drive - but specifically for code.

Every time you finish a build session, you will save your work to GitHub. This does two things:
· It keeps a full history of every change you've ever made, so you can always go back to a version that worked.
· It connects your code to Vercel, the tool that puts your app live on the internet. Without GitHub, there is no live URL.

GitHub is free. Setup takes about 10 minutes. You only need to do this once.

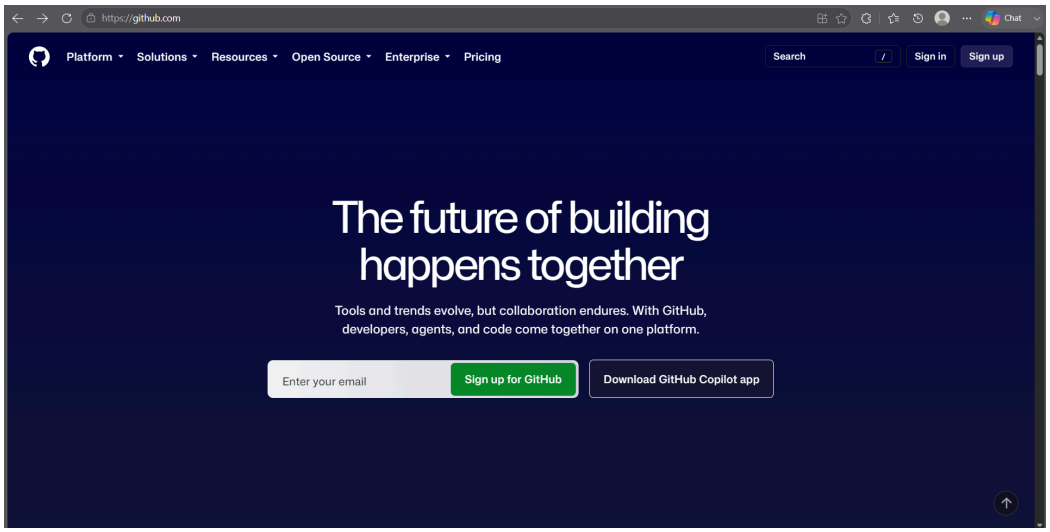
BEFORE YOU START

· Use a personal email address - not your MESA Workspace email.
· Do this on a laptop or desktop, not a phone.
· Have a password manager or notes app open to save credentials.
· If you already have a GitHub account, skip Part 1 and go straight to Part 2 (Creating a Personal Access Token). You will still need to complete Part 2 even if your account already exists.

PART 1 — CREATE YOUR GITHUB ACCOUNT

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Go to **github.com** and click **Sign up** (top-right corner button).

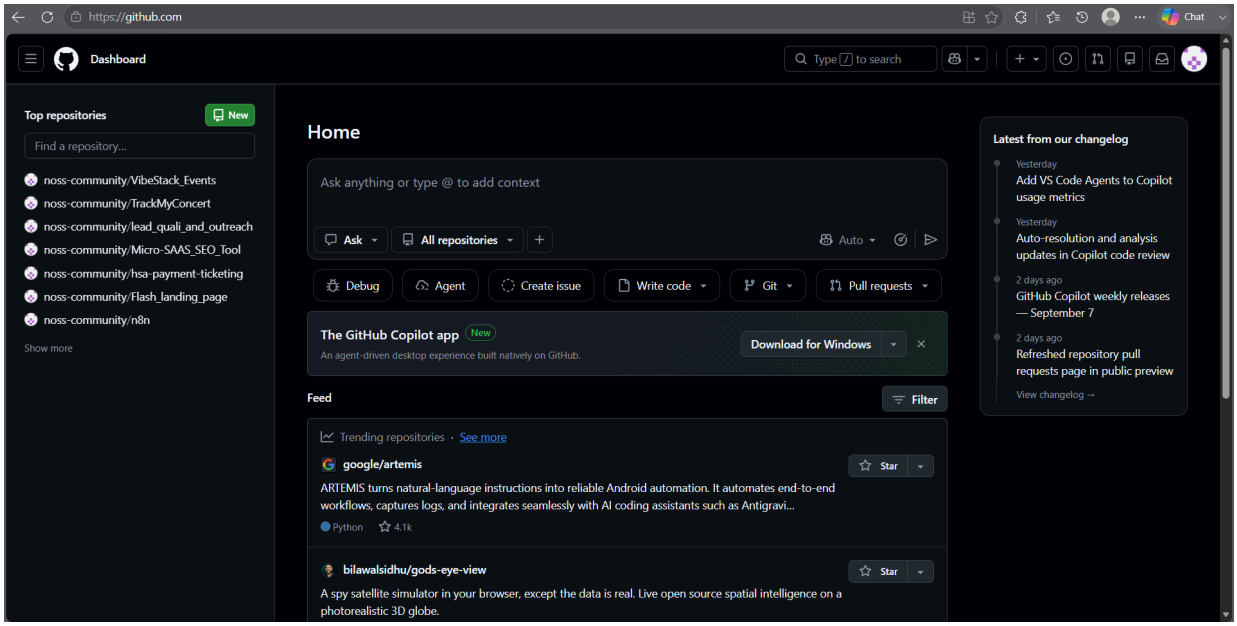


Work through the sign-up flow:

- Enter your personal email address (not your MESA Workspace email)
- Create a password and save it somewhere safe
- Choose a username — use your name or a variation of it, keep it professional, it will appear in your portfolio

When prompted to verify your email, check your inbox for a code from GitHub and enter it. Check spam if it doesn't arrive within a few minutes.

Skip the personalisation survey at the end - there's a "Skip personalisation" link at the bottom of that page.



That's it for account creation. Your username is now set. Write it down - you'll need it alongside your token in Part 2.

Do not close this tab. Continue to Part 2.

PART 2 — CREATE A PERSONAL ACCESS TOKEN

WHY DO YOU NEED A PERSONAL ACCESS TOKEN?

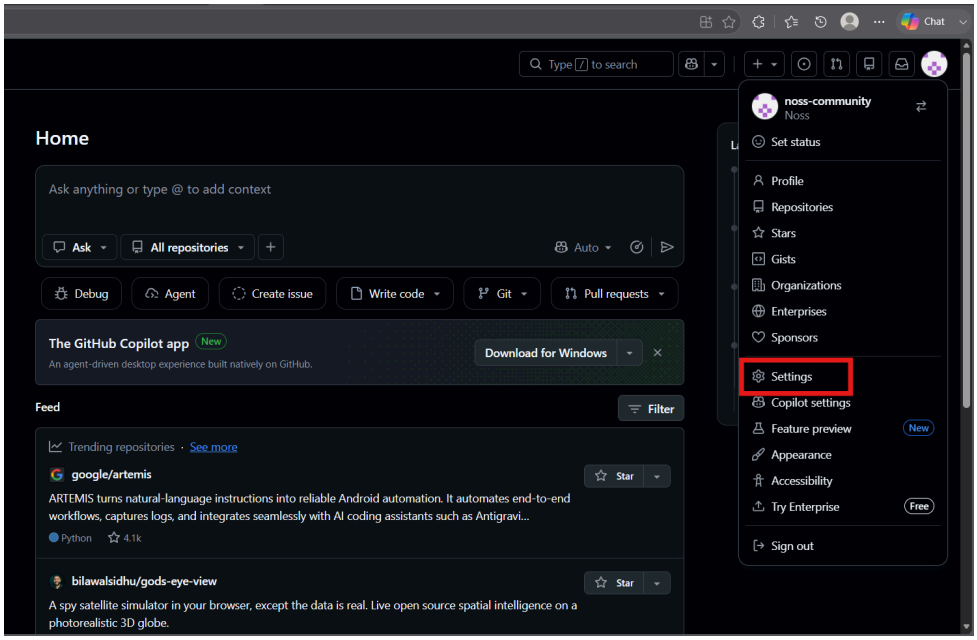
When Claude Code pushes your project to GitHub, it needs a way to prove that it is you — that you have given it permission to do so. A Personal Access Token (PAT) is that proof.

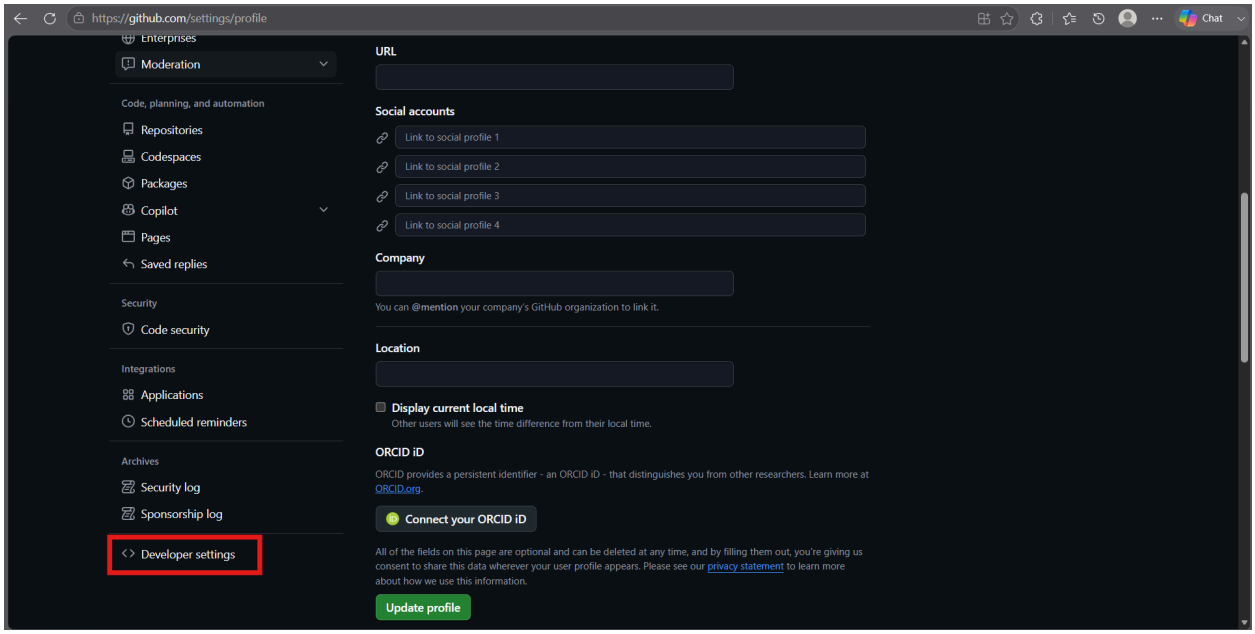
Think of it like a spare key to your house. You give one to a trusted person (Claude Code) so they can come in and drop something off on your behalf. You control what they can access and you can cancel the key at any time.

This token will be stored securely in your .env file. It never gets uploaded to GitHub or shared with anyone.

Step 1 — Open Developer Settings

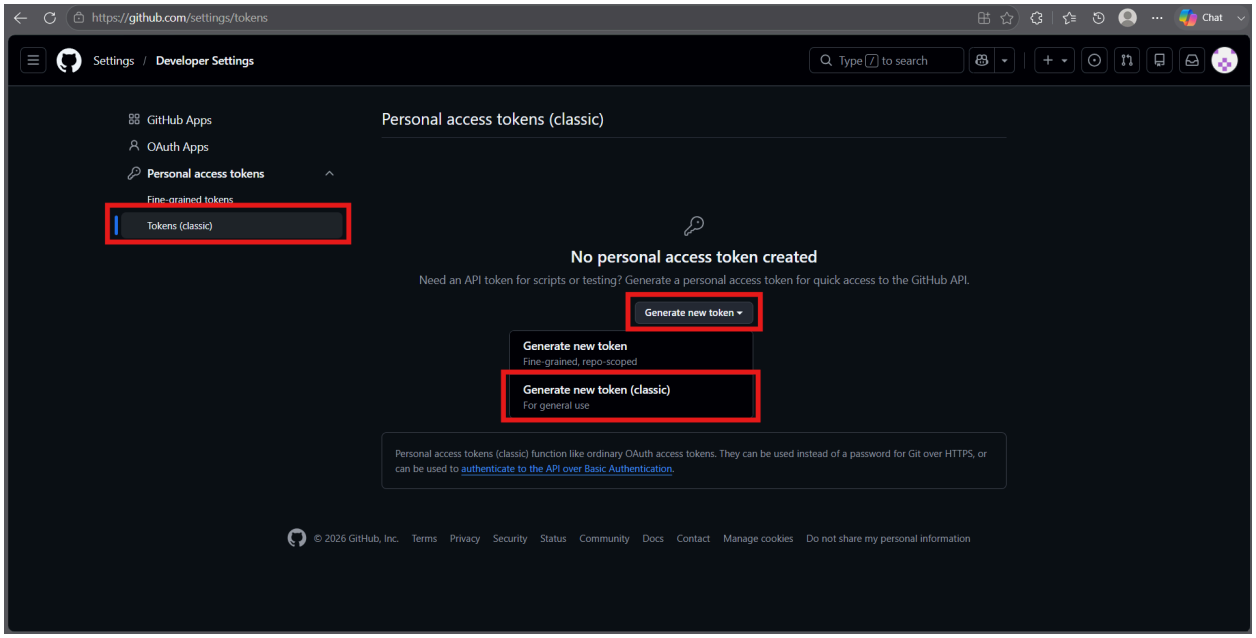
Click your profile picture in the top right corner of the GitHub dashboard. From the dropdown, click **Settings**. On the Settings page, scroll all the way down the left sidebar to the very last item - **Developer settings** - and click it.





Step 2 — Navigate to Personal Access Tokens

In the Developer Settings sidebar, click **Personal access tokens** → **Tokens (classic)**. Then click **Generate new token** → **Generate new token (classic)**. GitHub may ask you to re-enter your password before continuing.

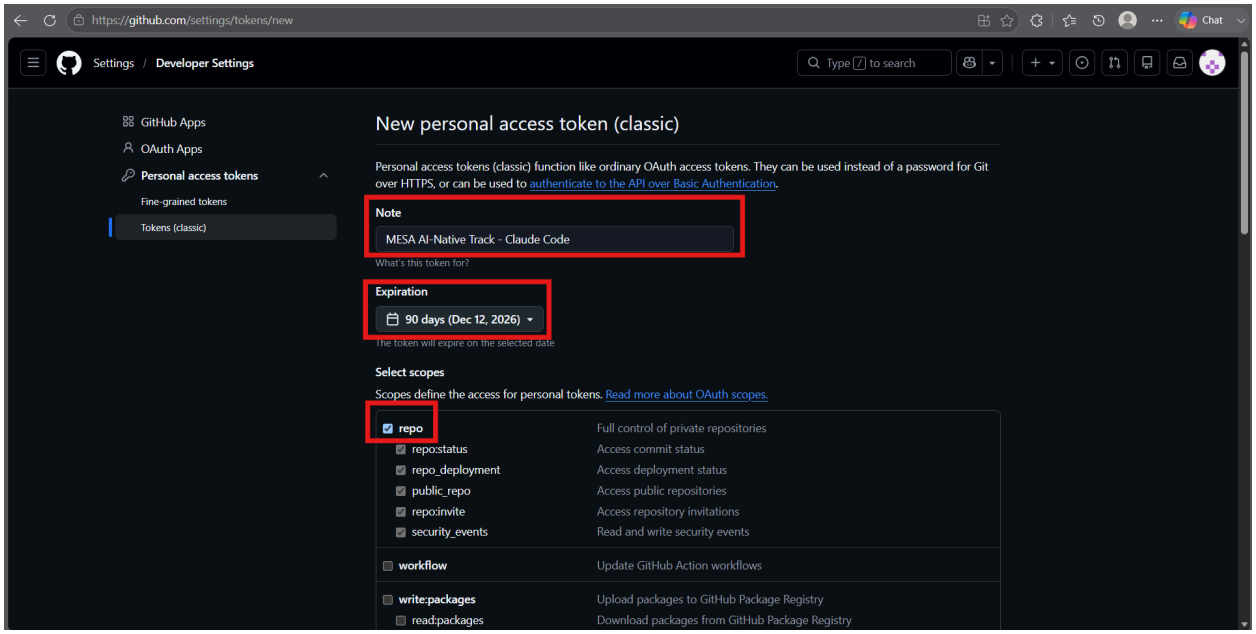


Step 3 — Configure and generate your token

Fill in the form as follows:

· **Note:** MESA AI-Native Track - Claude Code
· **Expiration:** 90 days
· **Scopes:** Tick the **repo** checkbox at the top of the list. All sub-items will auto-select. Don't tick anything else.

Click the green **Generate token** button at the bottom.



Step 4 — Copy and save your token immediately

GitHub will display your token once - a long string beginning with **ghp_**. Copy it right now and save it somewhere safe on your device: a notes app, password manager, or a private document.

Do not share it with anyone. Do not paste it into WhatsApp or email.

YOU ARE DONE
